

THE NEWS DESK PACK • ANY STORY

News Desk Day



A 45-minute routine that turns any news story into a thinking lesson. Pick a story, pick a frame, run the method. 10 frames, one skeleton, no prep, fully on paper. Bell-ringer version on page 2.

AT A GLANCE

TIME	MATERIALS	TECH NEEDED	PREP
45 min (25 as a bell-ringer)	One frame per student (Frames PDF; typeable copy included) · the story, printed, projected, or read aloud · Slides (optional) · Teacher Guide (safe-story rules p.1, script per frame, rubric p.4) · board for the tally · pens	None — runs fully unplugged. Devices only add: Frames 1 and 8 can open a second source live	Pick a story (Teacher Guide p.1 rules) and a frame (table below). Print. That's it.

OBJECTIVES

ISTE 1.3.b

CCSS ELA RI.6.8

CCSS ELA W.6.1

CSTA 2-IC-20

CCSS Math 7.RP.A.3

On any story they are handed, students can...

- Trace a story's claims and judge which are backed by a second source. (*Frames 1, 8; rubric row "evidence"*)
- Compare who gains and who loses from a change in technology, make a call, defend it. (*Frames 2, 3, 9; rubric "claim"*)
- Turn a price change into a percent and a cost per unit, then into a plan. (*Frames 5, 6; rubric "method followed"*)
- Say plainly why the story matters to someone their age. (*every frame's "So what?"; rubric "said plainly"*)

PICK THE FRAME — STORY TYPE → FRAME

	THE STORY IS ABOUT...	FRAME	THE QUESTION IT ANSWERS
1	A claim that sounds too neat, or a post going viral	Fact Desk	Is it true?
2	A new tool, app, or feature that changes how people do something	The Trade	Who wins, who loses?
3	A school, city, or company setting a new rule	Write the Rule	What should the rule be?
4	A free app or site that changes owners or adds ads	Who Pays for Free?	If it's free, who pays?
5	A subscription, plan, or bundle sold in tiers	Unit Rate Receipt	Which deal is really cheaper?
6	A price going up or down	Percent Change Card	How big is the change, really?
7	An artist, game, or brand saying something copied them	Copy, Style, or Person?	What got copied?
8	A study, report, or survey with a big number in it	Source Check	Who's telling me this, and why?
9	An AI helper that can act on someone's photos, messages, or accounts	Permission Slip	What may it do on its own?
10	A theft, hack, outage, or loss	Risk Grid	What would hurt most to lose?

OPEN — HEADLINE ONLY (5 MIN)

Show or read the headline and nothing else. Ask: **"What question does this headline make you want to ask?"**

Take three answers, then name the frame: *"That's a Frame 2 question — who wins, who loses. That's today's frame."*

If nobody has a question: read the first sentence aloud and ask which word they would check. That is a Frame 1 question. *If every question is about a person:* "We frame the change, not the person. What changed?"

Hand-out (say it): "Frames out. Top box first: the story, where you saw it, the date. Then we read."

Q READ — MARK IT UP (10 MIN)

Students read the story once, printed, projected, or read aloud by you. While they read: underline every claim they could check, circle any word they don't know. Then pairs retell the story to each other in one sentence each. That retell is the check that they actually read it.

If the story is above their reading level: read it aloud yourself, pausing after each paragraph for a one-sentence retell from a volunteer. *If a student says "this is boring":* "Frames don't care if it's boring. They care if it's true, fair, or expensive. Which one is this?"

Transition (say it): "Story down. Frame up. Method steps in order — number one first, and don't skip to the boxes."

Q FRAME — RUN THE METHOD (20 MIN)

1. **Solo (12 min):** students work the numbered steps in order and fill the frame. You circulate with the script for that frame (Teacher Guide p.2–3): three quotable lines and what a strong answer looks like. Play the editor, not the answer key. Frames 3, 6, and 10 carry the most writing: on those three, run solo 16 and pair-check 4 instead of 12 and 8.

If a student stalls: "Which step are you on? Read it to me." The method is the help; you rarely need to add more. *If a pair finishes early:* they write the "So what?" for a different reader — a parent, a gamer, someone who runs a small shop.

Transition: "Swap frames with your partner. Read their evidence, not their answer. Ask them one question they can't dodge."

2. **Pair-check (8 min):** partners swap frames. Each reads the other's evidence and asks one question. Then frames go back and students fix one thing. The two-line "So what?" is written last, solo.

If partners just say "looks good": "Point at the step they skipped. Every frame has one." *If an odd number:* one group of three; the third reads both frames.

Transition: "Pens down. Frames face up. Share-out is one line each: your call, and the evidence behind it."

Q SHARE-OUT — ONE LINE EACH (10 MIN)

Round the room by pairs. Each pair gives one line: their verdict, call, or pick, plus the one piece of evidence behind it. Tally on the board (RUN / FIX / KILL, WORTH IT / NOT, whatever the frame decides). 15 pairs at 35 seconds each fit 30 students into 9 minutes. Close: **"The story changes every week. The method doesn't."** Collect frames; the "So what?" lines are the exit ticket, scored with the rubric (Teacher Guide p.4).

If two pairs disagree: score the evidence, not the answer. "Who named a source, followed a step, AND said it plainly? That pair wins the round." *If time runs short:* take one pair per tally column, then collect.

BELL-RINGER VARIANT — 25 MIN

Open 2 — headline only; one question from the room, you name the frame. **Read 5** — you read the story aloud once; one volunteer retells it. **Frame 15** — solo, no pair-check; steps in order, "So what?" last. **Share-out 3** — three volunteers, one line each. Collect; same rubric.

If 15 minutes is not enough: Frames 3, 6, and 10 are the long ones. For a bell-ringer, run Frames 1, 2, 4, 7, 8, or 9.

DIFFERENTIATION

- **Support:** Start with Frames 1, 7, or 9 (fewest steps). Use the "Need a start?" sentence frames on Frames 3, 4, 7, and 9. Fill the story slot on the board together.
- **ELL:** Read the story aloud twice; pairs retell before anyone writes. Method words (claim, source, verdict, percent) are defined in the steps on each frame. Draft the "So what?" in the strongest language first, then translate.
- **Extension:** Run a second frame on the same story (if it fits two, this is the other one). One sentence: what did the second frame show that the first missed?
- **No-device classrooms:** Built in — the routine runs on paper; students NAME the second source they would check. **With devices:** Frames 1 and 8 open that source live; Frames 5 and 6 check the math on a calculator.